capacity. The four primal requirements of a state are the criminal justice system, the judiciary, the tax system and financial regulation. Our prime objective should be to learn how to be a capable state in these four areas.

We share the objectives of people working in numerous fields—total factor productivity, infrastructure, better design of poverty programmes, urbanization, sustainability, etc. There is intricate domain knowledge in each field such as agriculture. Each of these is a compelling area, where there are great possibilities, and where the impact will be enormous. The public economics and public administration of this book are a general toolkit that can be applied in diverse settings, that can set off virtuous cycles of progress in all these areas.